CMPN5006 Recording Portfolio

A DAY INDOORS

The Final Chapter of Our Sound Narrative

Part of a collaborative sound narrative exploring memory through everyday environments.

final produced audio click here

raw audio click here

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Introduction

Some memories return not as images, but as sounds.

As part of our group's exploration of memory through sound, my contribution focuses on the final stage of the daily journey: the sounds of home.

After transport, campus life, and the city environment, the listener returns home. The sounds of gaming, household routines, and bedtime activities gradually replace the noise of public spaces.

These recordings capture comfort, routine, and the quiet atmosphere that marks the end of a day. They represent the transition from public experiences to private memories.

Recording Concept

Gaming

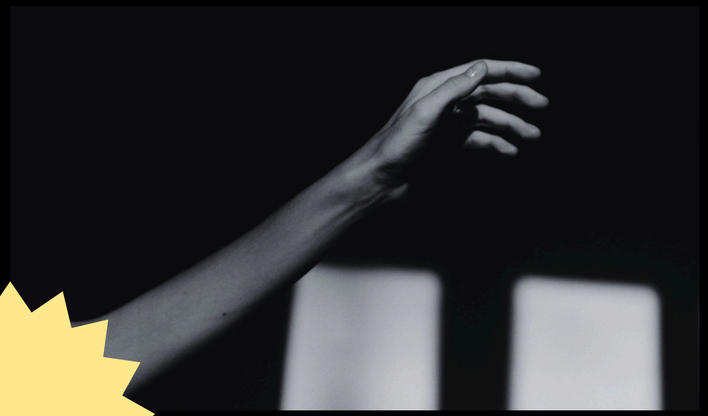
Dishwasher

Brushing Teeth

Sleep Preparation

Group Storyline: Sydney > Transport > Campus > Home > Gaming > Dishwasher > Brushing Teeth > Sleep

My Contribution: Home > Gaming > Dishwasher > Brushing Teeth > Sleep
Final chapter: leisure, domestic routine, and bedtime activity create closure after city and campus noise fades away.



Practical Experience

The recordings contrast with the busy public environments presented earlier in the group project.

While previous sections focused on movement, travel, and campus activity, my section focuses on stillness, routine, and personal space.

Gaming suggests relaxation after returning home; the dishwasher represents domestic routine; brushing teeth and water mark the final moments before sleep.

This contrast completes the narrative arc from the external world back into the intimacy of home.

These familiar domestic sounds were chosen because they are closely connected to personal memories and everyday routines. They help transform ordinary activities into meaningful moments within the broader narrative of the project.

Challenges & Solutions

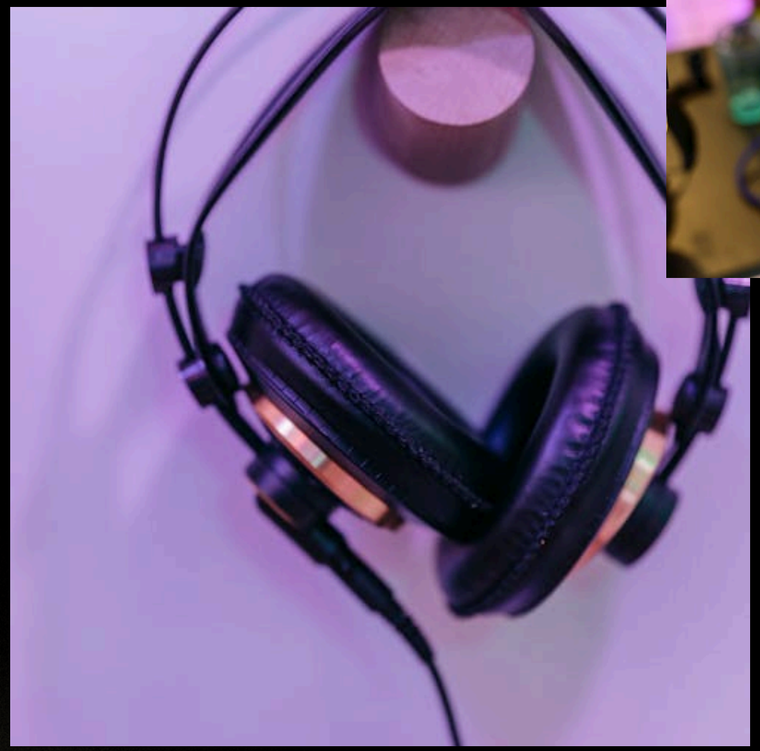
Challenge 1:

Creating a convincing transition from public soundscapes to private domestic spaces.
Solution:
Scene-based sequencing and loudness balancing.

Challenge 2:
Fan noise in dishwasher recordings.
Solution:
Noise reduction and frequency filtering.

Challenge 3:
Loudness mismatch.
Solution:
Loudness balancing and scene mixing.

Challenge 4:
Abrupt transitions.
Solution:
Crossfade editing.



Equipment

- Zoom Recorder
- Stereo Recording Setup
- Headphones
- Editing Software

Stereo recording preserved environmental detail and realism.

The recording setup was selected to capture intimate domestic sounds while maintaining consistency with the wider soundscape developed by the group.

The recorder was positioned differently for each recording to balance direct sound and environmental ambience.

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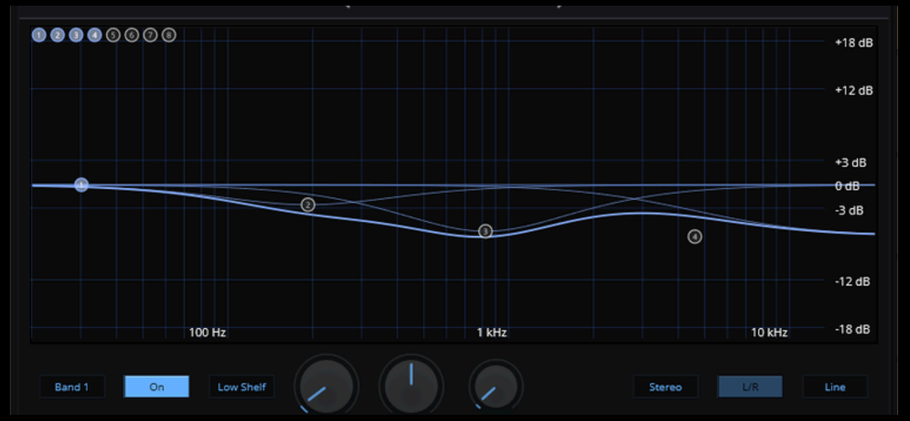


Sounds as Memory

Rather than documenting events directly, this project explores how sounds can trigger memories and emotions.

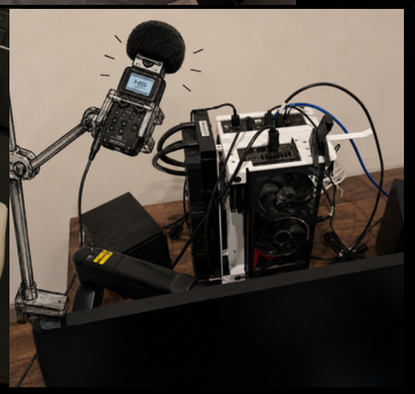
The recordings matter because of what they remind us of. Everyday sounds such as gaming, washing dishes, and brushing teeth become markers of routine, comfort, and belonging.

Through sound, ordinary moments are transformed into memories.

Post-Production Process

- **Recording**
- **Noise Analysis**
- **Noise Reduction**
- **Loudness Matching**
- **Scene Mixing**
- **Mastering**

AI-generated illustrations were used to reconstruct the recording setups because photographs were not taken during the recording sessions.
To reduce unwanted noise and avoid interference with the field recordings, the project was completed individually without additional personnel present. This approach helped maintain the authenticity and quality of the recorded soundscape but prevented photographic documentation of the recording process.
The images therefore serve as visual reconstructions of the actual recording environments, equipment, and microphone placements used in the project. They are intended to support the explanation of the recording methodology and do not represent photographs captured during the original sessions.



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The next slide provides a detailed description of our work and editorial process.

Working: Editing & Mixing

During the editing stage, I was responsible for selecting usable sections from the gameplay, dishwasher, and toothbrush recordings, arranging them into a coherent sound narrative, and preparing the final master mix.

My main focus was reducing unwanted noise, balancing loudness between recordings, and creating smooth transitions between scenes. Particular attention was given to the dishwasher recording, where background fan noise and low-frequency mechanical sounds required additional processing to maintain clarity while preserving the natural character of the recording.

I applied techniques introduced throughout the course, including trimming, crossfading, noise reduction, loudness matching, equalisation, and scene-based mixing. Rather than presenting the recordings as separate clips, the final piece was edited as a continuous sound journey. Each recording was carefully adjusted to maintain a consistent listening experience while supporting the narrative progression from relaxation, to domestic routine, and finally to bedtime preparation.

Several revisions were completed before the final export. The resulting mix provides a smoother flow between scenes and better reflects the role of sound in shaping memory, routine, and personal space.

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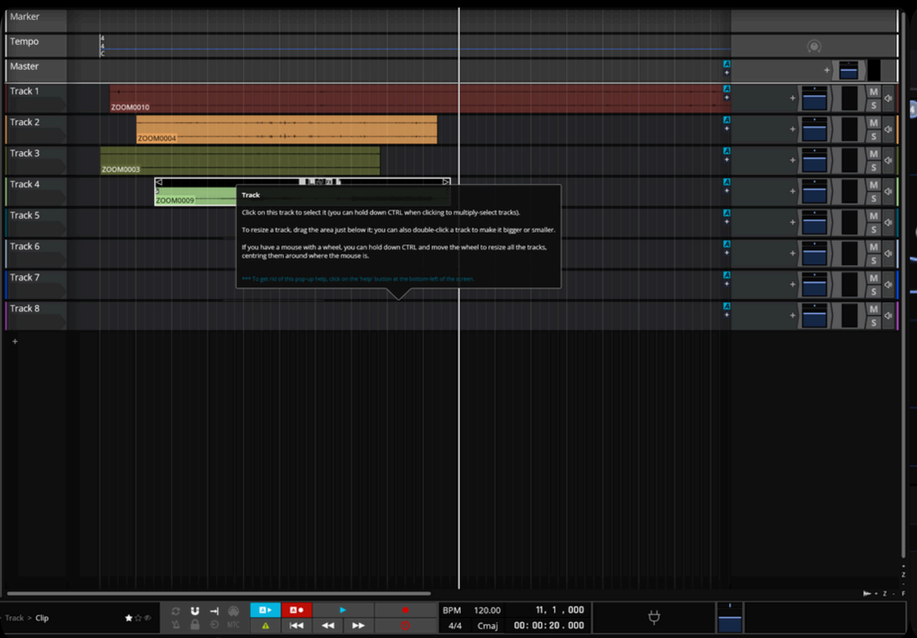
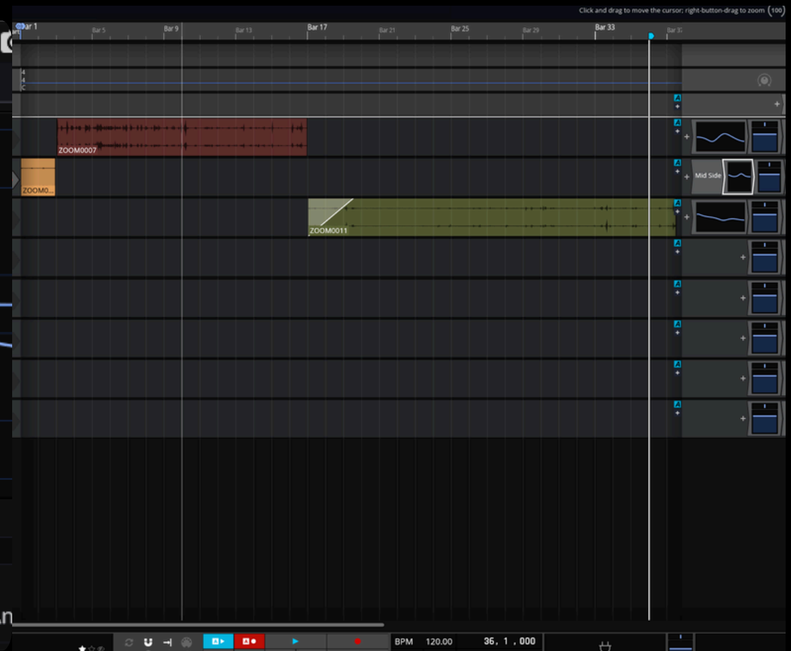
Raw sound wave



Produced sound wave



Reflection

This project provided a profound realization that sound possesses an innate power to communicate complex emotions and evoke vivid memories, entirely independent of visual imagery. By stripping away the reliance on the visual, I learned to listen more intently, discovering that auditory textures can convey intimacy, nostalgia, and tension with startling clarity.

As I took responsibility for the "home" section of our group's collaborative sound journey, I underwent a significant creative shift. I learned how seemingly mundane, ordinary domestic sounds—the rhythmic ticking of a clock, the hum of a refrigerator, or the subtle shifting of floorboards—could be transformed into powerful narrative elements. These sounds, once considered background noise, became the emotional anchors of my contribution, grounding the listener in a tangible, relatable sense of place.

Technically, the project was instrumental in refining my craft. I significantly advanced my abilities in field recording, meticulous audio editing, and nuanced sound design. I learned the importance of patience in capturing the right ambiance and the precision required in post-production to shape a soundscape. However, this process also highlighted areas for future growth. I aim to achieve cleaner, more professional recordings in the future, implement more advanced mastering techniques to ensure high-fidelity output, and develop a more sophisticated approach to the transitions between sections, ensuring that the shift from one auditory environment to another feels seamless and intentional.

Finally, working within a collaborative framework taught me the vital importance of maintaining narrative continuity. It is not enough to create high-quality individual segments; one must ensure these pieces resonate together to form a unified, cohesive story. Understanding how individual recordings can be stitched together into a larger sonic architecture was perhaps the most rewarding takeaway, fundamentally changing how I approach storytelling through sound.

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AI USAGE STATEMENT

AI-generated illustrations were used solely for the reconstruction of recording setups and microphone placements. These images were created based on the actual recording locations, equipment, and workflows used in the project. They are intended as explanatory visualisations and do not represent photographs taken during the original recording sessions.

LINKS

https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1nig6G0QePzAARfzpVkTOeeRrT2rDy3iq
https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1u7fFri15bHMeYd656vgBhvOsiICjv690

Appendix

Sound Map